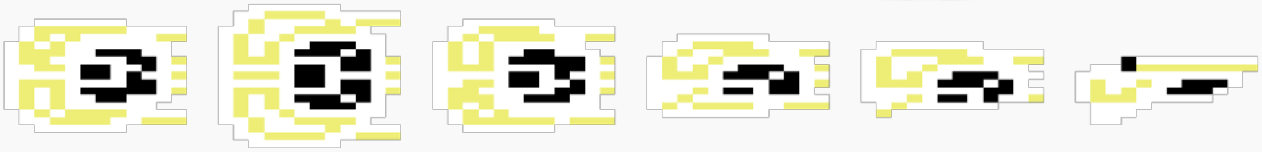
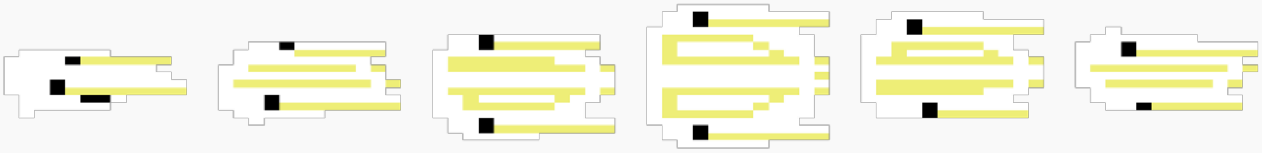
URIDIUM/ FRAKTION


MANTA/00 MANTA/01 MANTA/02 MANTA/03 MANTA/04 MANTA/05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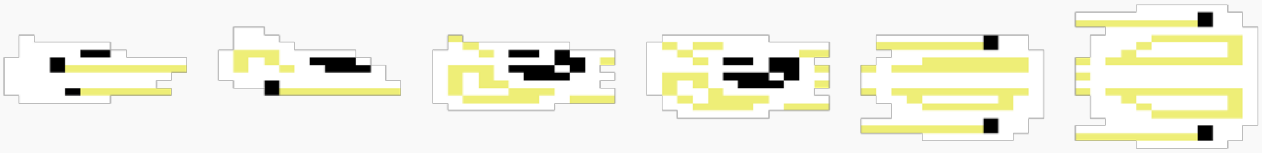
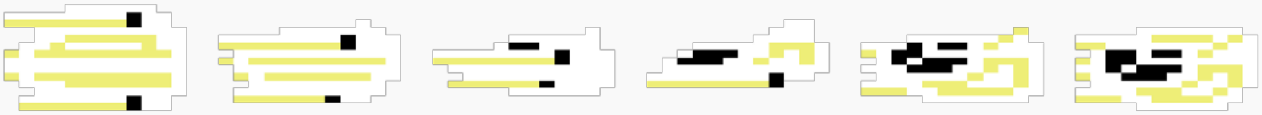

MANTA/12 MANTA/13 MANTA/14 MANTA/15 MANTA/16 MANTA/17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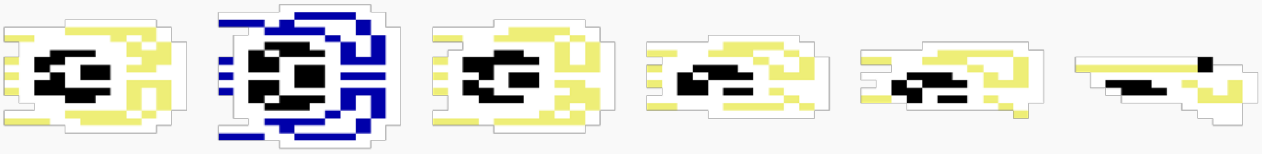
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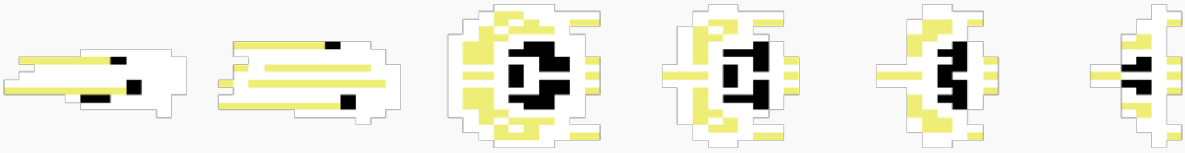
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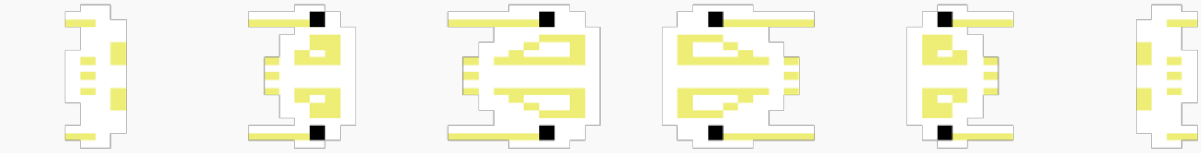
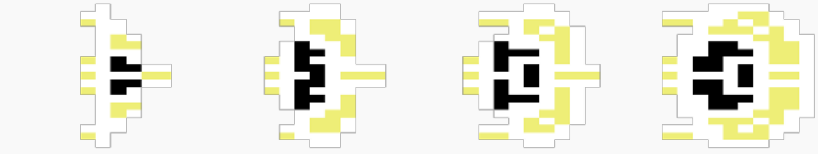

MANTA/36 MANTA/37 MANTA/38 MANTA/39 MANTA/40 MANTA/41


MANTA/42 MANTA/43 MANTA/44 MANTA/45

OBJECTS/ AND/ EFFECTS

URIDIUM/ FRAKTION

For Edna.

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Edition Date: Sunday 12th April, 2026

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ABOUT/THIS/BOOK

This book isn't about the history of *Tempest* or its importance in the history of computer games. This is a book about computer code. Each chapter aims to be an easily digested sketch of how a specific feature or effect was achieved. In the case of *Tempest* this means sifting through the 6502 assembly code David Theurer wrote by hand(!) to create the game, and wrangling with the bits and bytes of Atari's Quadrascan Vector Graphics. For *Tempest 2000* it means familiarizing ourselves with Motorola 68K assembly code and the Jaguar's powerful hardware platform.

There are lots of fascinating bits and pieces to pore over. And it is interesting to see how the years that separate the two games leave some things unchanged and many other things changed utterly. I've put together this book of squibs in the hope they will allow you, the reader, to digest small bite-sized insights into each game. And I hope, by interleaving elements from *Tempest* and *Tempest 2000*, to enable you to compare the parallel lives in the design and execution of separate incarnations of the same classic video game.

Rob Hogan (@mwenge)
2026

URIDIUM/
FRAKTION

MANTA/SPIN

When waiting to start the first level, the player's Manta ship spins elegantly in the center of the screen. This simple animation uses an enormous number of sprites - 16 in total.

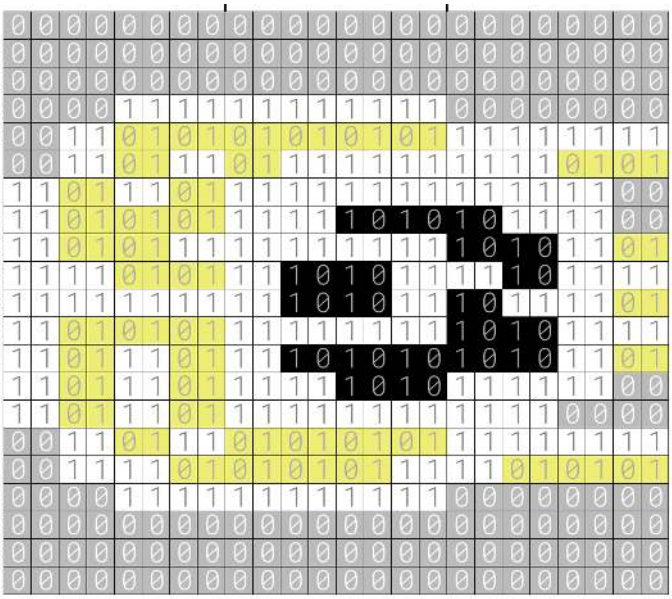
The first phase of the spin - - does not start from where we might expect. The rotation of the initial ship is negative so that we start from a slightly rotated position.

The next frame in the animation - - rotates the ship to the opposite roll position.

So the Manta starts tilted away from us, rotates to a flat position, and then begins its roll towards us. Notice the subtly different assymetry in the cockpit of the Manta when it is rolled away from us compared to when it is rolled towards us. It is easiest to compare this difference in detail on the following page where we blow up each of the tilted sprites to see how they are constructed from their source data.

URIDIUM/MANTA/00

SPEC:MANTA
AZIMUTH:090°
OFFSET:$40
ELEVATION:000°
RAM:$5000
ROLL:015°

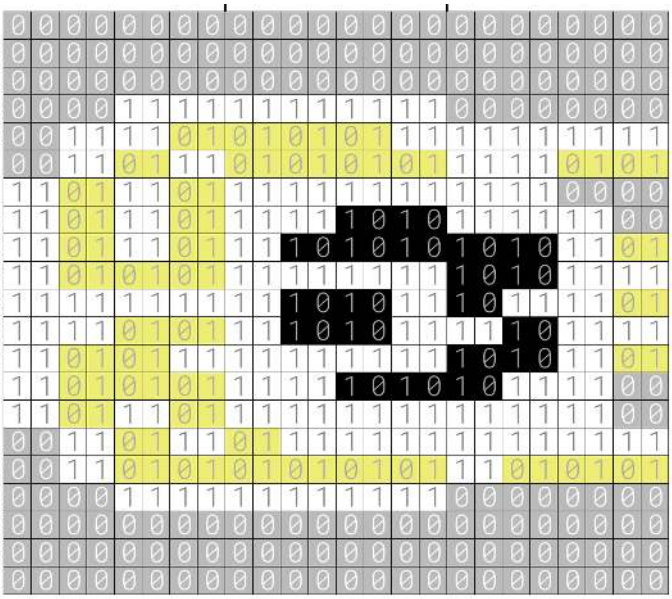


```
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $0F,$FF,$00
.BYTE $35,$55,$FF
.BYTE $37,$7F,$F5
.BYTE $DD,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $D5,$FA,$BC
.BYTE $D7,$FF,$AD
.BYTE $F5,$EB,$EF
.BYTE $FF,$EB,$BD
.BYTE $D5,$FF,$AF
.BYTE $DD,$EA,$AD
.BYTE $DD,$FA,$FC
.BYTE $DD,$FF,$F0
.BYTE $37,$55,$FF
.BYTE $3D,$57,$D5
.BYTE $0F,$FF,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
```

BASE_COLOR:□ MULTI_COLOR0:□ MULTI_COLOR1:■

URIDIUM/MANTA/02

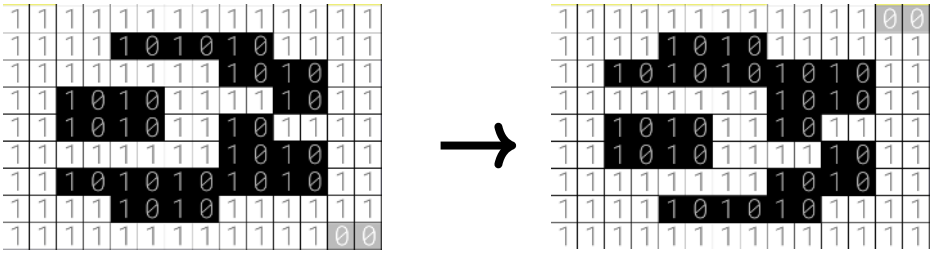
SPEC:MANTA_2
AZIMUTH:090°
OFFSET:$42
ELEVATION:000°
RAM:$5080
ROLL:015°



```
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $0F,$FF,$00
.BYTE $3D,$57,$FF
.BYTE $37,$55,$F5
.BYTE $DD,$FF,$F0
.BYTE $DD,$FA,$FC
.BYTE $DD,$EA,$AD
.BYTE $D5,$FF,$AF
.BYTE $FF,$EB,$BD
.BYTE $F5,$EB,$EF
.BYTE $D7,$FF,$AD
.BYTE $D5,$FA,$BC
.BYTE $DD,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $37,$7F,$FF
.BYTE $35,$55,$D5
.BYTE $0F,$FF,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
```

BASE_COLOR:□ MULTI_COLOR0:□ MULTI_COLOR1:■

Closer inspection reveals a simple trick that behind this detailing: the yellow and black regions have simply had their order reversed and are mirror images of each other. For example if we take a look at the region representing the cockpit:

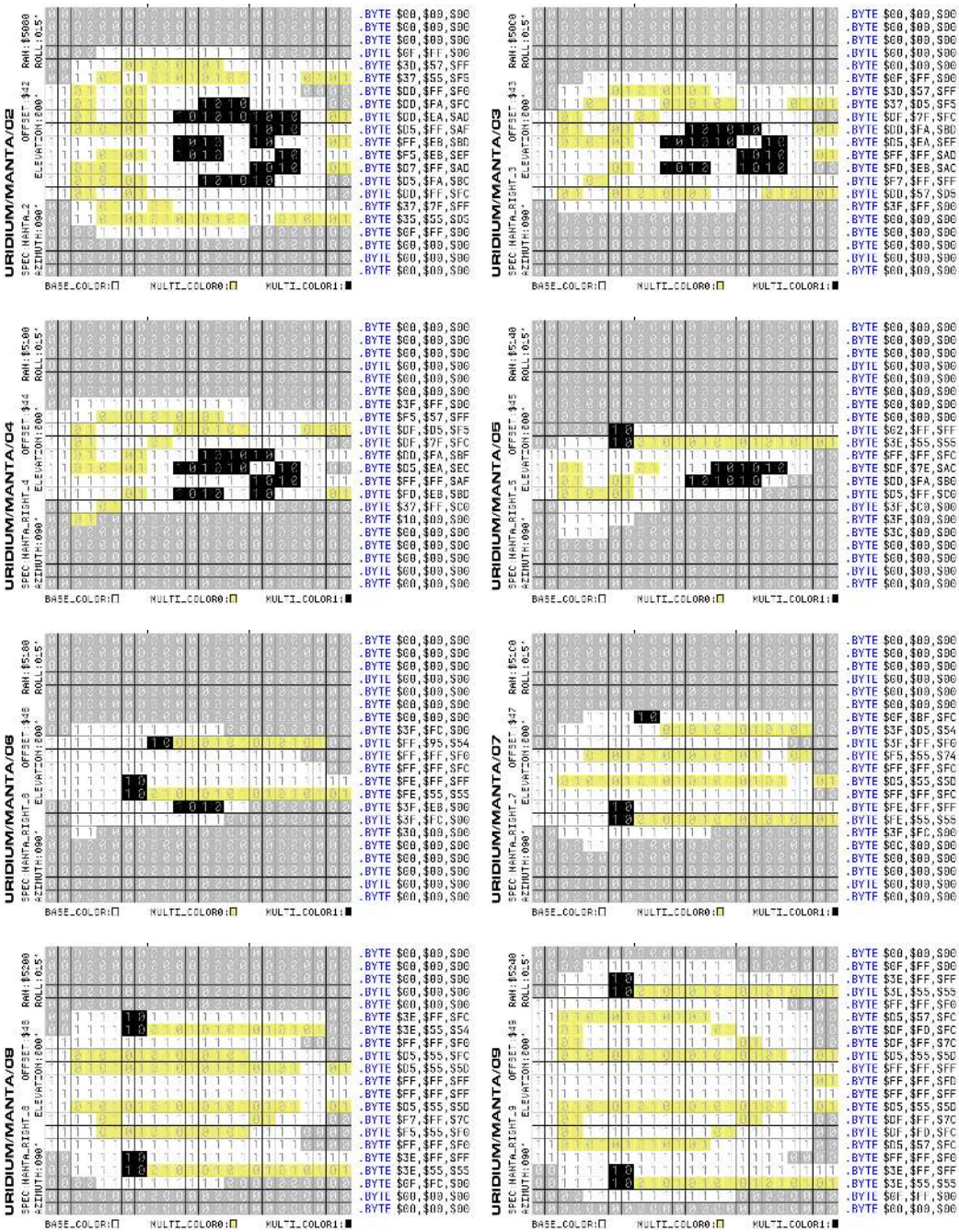


In its simplest terms the vertical order of the black lines detailing the cockpit have been reversed and this alone is enough to suggest the difference in attitude along the Y co-ordinate.

Examining this detail may also give you a sense of how the sprites themselves are defined. In the diagram above, for example, it may now be obvious that the black colour is defined by a bit pair of `10` and that the white colour is defined by a bit pair of `11`. In the diagrams opposite, we can further see that yellow is defined by the bit paid `01` and the transparent background of the sprite by `00`.

In the diagrams opposite and elsewhere we have given the three bytes that together make up the 12 bit pairs constituting each of the 21 lines in the sprite, a total of 63 bytes in total. This is the source data used by *Uridium's* 6502 assembler code to build each sprite using the straightforward process of mapping each bit pair to a corresponding pair of coloured pixels. An important feature of this sprite data is that it is stored contiguously for all sprites in the computer's RAM, or memory area, starting at address `$5000`. This is important because the order in which the sprite data is stored corresponds exactly to the order of each frame in the manta spin animation.

We can get a better sense of this by observing the RAM address of each sprite in the section of animation sequence between the ship faced towards and faced away. The first sprite in the sequence is at address `$5040`, the second at `$5080`, and so on. At each step, to get the next frame in the animation all that has to be done is to increment the position in RAM we are adressing by `$40`.


URIDIUM/MANTA/02
SPEC MANTA_2 OFFSET $42 RAH:$5080
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR: MULTI_COLOR0: MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIL $0F,$FF,$90
.BYTE $3D,$57,$FF
.BYTE $37,$55,$F5
.BYTE $DD,$FF,$F0
.BYTE $DD,$FA,$FC
.BYTE $DD,$EA,$AD
.BYTE $D5,$FF,$AF
.BYTE $FF,$EB,$BD
.BYTE $F5,$EB,$EF
.BYTE $D7,$FF,$AD
.BYTE $D5,$FA,$BC
.BYIE $DD,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $37,$7F,$FF
.BYTE $35,$55,$D5
.BYTE $0F,$FF,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIL $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
URIDIUM/MANTA/03
SPEC MANTA_RIGHT_3 OFFSET $43 RAH:$50C0
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR: MULTI_COLOR0: MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIL $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $0F,$FF,$90
.BYTE $3D,$57,$FF
.BYTE $37,$D5,$F5
.BYIE $DF,$7F,$FC
.BYTE $DD,$FA,$BD
.BYTE $D5,$FA,$FF
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$AD
.BYTE $FD,$EB,$AC
.BYTE $F7,$FF,$FF
.BYIE $DD,$57,$D5
.BYTE $3F,$FF,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIL $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
URIDIUM/MANTA/04
SPEC MANTA_RIGHT_4 OFFSET $44 RAH:$5100
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR: MULTI_COLOR0: MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIL $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $3F,$FF,$90
.BYTE $F5,$57,$FF
.BYTE $DF,$D5,$F5
.BYTE $DF,$7F,$FC
.BYTE $DD,$FA,$BF
.BYTE $D5,$EA,$EC
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$AF
.BYTE $FD,$EB,$BD
.BYIE $37,$FF,$C0
.BYTE $10,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIL $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
URIDIUM/MANTA/05
SPEC MANTA_RIGHT_5 OFFSET $45 RAH:$5140
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR: MULTI_COLOR0: MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIL $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIE $C2,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $3E,$55,$55
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $DF,$7E,$AC
.BYTE $DD,$FA,$B0
.BYTE $D5,$FF,$C0
.BYTE $3F,$C0,$90
.BYTE $3F,$09,$90
.BYTE $3C,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIL $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
URIDIUM/MANTA/06
SPEC MANTA_RIGHT_6 OFFSET $46 RAH:$5180
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR: MULTI_COLOR0: MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIL $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $3F,$FC,$90
.BYIE $FF,$95,$54
.BYIE $FF,$FF,$F0
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $FE,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $FE,$55,$55
.BYTE $3F,$EB,$90
.BYIE $3F,$FC,$90
.BYTE $30,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIL $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
URIDIUM/MANTA/07
SPEC MANTA_RIGHT_7 OFFSET $47 RAH:$51C0
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR: MULTI_COLOR0: MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIL $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $0F,$BF,$FC
.BYTE $3F,$D5,$54
.BYIE $3F,$FF,$F0
.BYIE $F5,$55,$74
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $D5,$55,$50
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $FE,$FF,$FF
.BYIE $FE,$55,$55
.BYTE $3F,$FC,$90
.BYTE $0C,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIL $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
URIDIUM/MANTA/08
SPEC MANTA_RIGHT_8 OFFSET $48 RAH:$5200
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR: MULTI_COLOR0: MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYIL $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $3E,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $3E,$55,$54
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$F0
.BYIE $D5,$55,$FC
.BYIE $D5,$55,$50
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $D5,$55,$50
.BYTE $F7,$FF,$7C
.BYIL $F5,$55,$F0
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$F0
.BYTE $3E,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $3E,$55,$55
.BYTE $0F,$FC,$90
.BYIL $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
URIDIUM/MANTA/09
SPEC MANTA_RIGHT_9 OFFSET $49 RAH:$5240
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR: MULTI_COLOR0: MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$09,$90
.BYTE $0F,$FF,$90
.BYTE $3E,$FF,$FF
.BYIL $3L,$55,$55
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$F0
.BYTE $D5,$57,$FC
.BYTE $DF,$FD,$FC
.BYTE $DF,$FF,$7C
.BYIL $D5,$55,$5D
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FD
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $D5,$55,$5D
.BYTE $DF,$FF,$7C
.BYIL $DF,$FD,$FC
.BYTE $D5,$57,$FC
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$F0
.BYTE $3E,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $3E,$55,$55
.BYIL $0L,$II,$90
.BYTE $00,$09,$90

This approach does not hold for the second half of the animation sequence, or at least not all of it. As we can see below, the final two frames of the sequence reset back to address $5000 to stitch in the start of the animation and complete the loop.

But this is not a wrinkle the animation needs to worry about. All it needs to do is loop across the sprites that constitute the full sequence. It is indifferent to the fact that the first frame in RAM is not a manta sitting flush to our point of view.

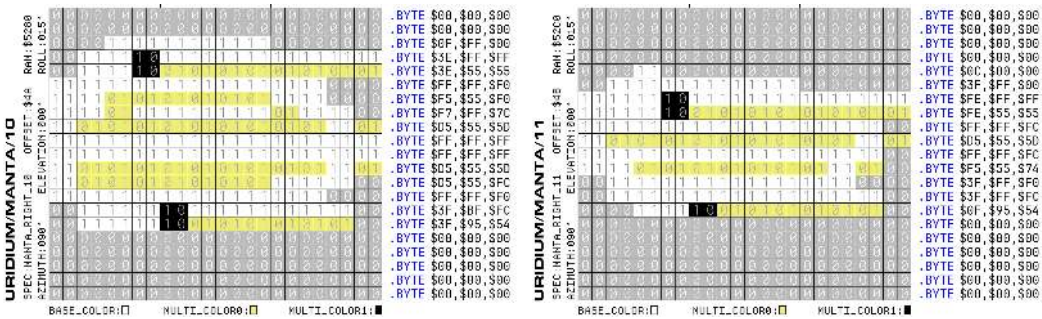
Let's take a look at how it is implemented in the routine responsible for animating the spinning manta. It's thankfully very compact and easy to digest. We would expect it to iterate over the sprites from `MANTA_0` to `MANTA_15`, which is exactly what it does - as we noted, all that matters to it is that the sprites are ordered contiguously in RAM. Selecting the next sprite for preparation (`GetCurrentSprite`) and display (`DisplaySprite`) is a simple matter of incrementing the index `currentSpriteValue` that points to the current sprite until we reach `MANTA_16`, at which point we reset our `currentSpriteValue` back to `MANTA_0`.

```
SpinningShipLoop
    JSR CheckInput            ; Increment frameCount and check input.
    LDA firePressed           ; Was 'Fire' pressed?
    BEQ AnimationOver         ; If so, stop animating ship.
    LDA frameCount            ; Is the sequence over?
    BEQ AnimationOver         ; If so, stop animating ship.
    JSR MaybeShowPauseScreen  ; Check if 'Pause' pressed.
    JSR GetCurrentSprite      ; Prepare current sprite.
    INC currentSpriteValue    ; Increment the sprite index.
    LDA currentSpriteValue    ; Store it in 'A' register.
    CMP #MANTA_16             ; Is it MANTA_16 yet?
    BCC Repeat                ; If not, display sprite and loop.
    LDA #MANTA_00             ; Otherwise, fetch MANTA_00 ..
    STA currentSpriteValue    ; .. and store it as current sprite.
Repeat
    JSR DisplayCurrentSprite  ; Display our selected sprite.
    JMP SpinningShipLoop      ; Loop back to top again.
```

But there is one complication we haven't yet accounted for: how does the animation ensure that when `frameCount` has reached zero, and the animation is over, that we finish with the Manta facing upwards: ? The answer lies in the initial value that we set for `frameCount`. This is $BF or 191 in decimal:

```
    LDA #$BF          ; Store 191 in the A register.
    STA frameCount    ; Store it as our frameCount.
```

MANTA/SPIN


URIDIUM/MANTA/10
SPEC MANTA_RIGHT_10 OFFSET $4A RAH:$5200
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR:
MULTI_COLOR0:
MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $0F,$FF,$00
.BYTE $3L,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $3E,$55,$55
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$F0
.BYTE $F5,$55,$F0
.BYTE $F7,$FF,$7C
.BYTE $D5,$55,$5D
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $D5,$55,$5D
.BYTE $D5,$55,$FC
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$F0
.BYTE $3F,$BF,$FC
.BYTE $3F,$95,$54
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
URIDIUM/MANTA/11
SPEC MANTA_RIGHT_11 OFFSET $4B RAH:$5200
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR:
MULTI_COLOR0:
MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $0C,$00,$00
.BYTE $3F,$FF,$00
.BYTE $FE,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $FE,$55,$55
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $D5,$55,$5D
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $F5,$55,$74
.BYTE $3F,$FF,$F0
.BYTE $3F,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $0F,$95,$54
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
URIDIUM/MANTA/12
SPEC MANTA_RIGHT_12 OFFSET $4C RAH:$5300
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR:
MULTI_COLOR0:
MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $30,$00,$00
.BYTE $3F,$FC,$00
.BYTE $3F,$EB,$00
.BYTE $FE,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $FE,$55,$55
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$F0
.BYTE $FF,$95,$54
.BYTE $3F,$FC,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
URIDIUM/MANTA/13
SPEC MANTA_RIGHT_13 OFFSET $4D RAH:$5400
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR:
MULTI_COLOR0:
MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $3C,$00,$00
.BYTE $3F,$00,$00
.BYTE $3F,$C0,$00
.BYTE $D5,$FF,$C0
.BYTE $DD,$FA,$B0
.BYTE $DF,$7E,$AC
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $3E,$FF,$FF
.BYTE $02,$55,$55
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
URIDIUM/MANTA/14
SPEC MANTA_RIGHT_14 OFFSET $4E RAH:$5300
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR:
MULTI_COLOR0:
MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $10,$00,$00
.BYTE $37,$FF,$C0
.BYTE $F0,$EB,$BF
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$AD
.BYTE $D5,$EA,$EC
.BYTE $DD,$FA,$BF
.BYTE $DD,$7F,$FC
.BYTE $DF,$D5,$FF
.BYTE $F5,$57,$D5
.BYTE $3F,$FF,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
URIDIUM/MANTA/15
SPEC MANTA_RIGHT_15 OFFSET $4F RAH:$5300
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR:
MULTI_COLOR0:
MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $3F,$FF,$00
.BYTE $DD,$7F,$FF
.BYTE $F7,$FF,$F5
.BYTE $FD,$EB,$AC
.BYTE $FF,$FF,$AD
.BYTE $D5,$FA,$BF
.BYTE $DD,$FA,$B0
.BYTE $DF,$7F,$FC
.BYTE $37,$55,$FF
.BYTE $3D,$57,$D5
.BYTE $0F,$FF,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
URIDIUM/MANTA/00
SPEC MANTA OFFSET $40 RAH:$5000
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR:
MULTI_COLOR0:
MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $0F,$FF,$00
.BYTE $35,$55,$FF
.BYTE $37,$7F,$F5
.BYTE $DD,$FF,$FC
.BYTE $D5,$FA,$BC
.BYTE $D7,$FF,$AD
.BYTE $F5,$EB,$EF
.BYTE $FF,$FB,$BD
.BYTE $D5,$FF,$AF
.BYTE $DD,$EA,$AD
.BYTE $DD,$FA,$FC
.BYTE $UD,$FF,$F0
.BYTE $37,$55,$FF
.BYTE $3D,$57,$D5
.BYTE $0F,$FF,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
URIDIUM/MANTA/01
SPEC MANTA1 OFFSET $41 RAH:$5040
AZIMUTH:090° ELEVATION:200° ROLL:0.5°
BASE_COLOR:
MULTI_COLOR0:
MULTI_COLOR1:
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $0F,$FF,$00
.BYTE $3D,$57,$FF
.BYTE $37,$FD,$D5
.BYTE $F7,$D5,$70
.BYTE $DF,$7F,$FC
.BYTE $DD,$FA,$BC
.BYTE $DD,$EA,$EC
.BYTE $D5,$FF,$AD
.BYTE $FF,$EB,$AF
.BYTE $D5,$FB,$FD
.BYTE $FF,$EB,$AF
.BYTE $D5,$FF,$AD
.BYTE $DD,$EA,$EC
.BYTE $UD,$FA,$BC
.BYTE $DF,$7F,$FC
.BYTE $F7,$D5,$70
.BYTE $37,$FD,$FF
.BYTE $3D,$57,$D5
.BYTE $0L,$FL,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00

A starting value of 191 for `frameCount` gives us 65 keyframes of animation in total until we reach 256 and roll around, like a clock, back to zero. With 16 frames for each complete spin of the Manta this allows us 4 complete spins (64 frames) with one left over before `frameCount` will roll over to zero. It is this left over frame that will push us past `MANTA_00` - - and finish at the desired spot of `MANTA_1` - .

The Manta does not only spin on its axis when travelling from left to right. The effect is also present in the right-to-left direction during the enemy ship's destruction sequence.

This effect, along with a number of other Manta maneouvres, is achieved with a more involved use of data structures than has been necessary here. We will save a full description of these for a later chapter.

DROP/SHIP

The player deploys from a dropship. This ship is composed of 6 sprites tiled in two rows of three sprites each.

Individually these tiles are unremarkable - - and in the order that they appear it may not even be obvious that together they can form a whole. But when properly combined they give us a chrome dropship from which the player's craft can emerge:

As with the manta craft itself, each of these sprites is built up from 63 bytes of data. On the following page we can see the familiar diagrams from the rear of the dropship in detail.

URIDIUM/DROPSHIP/00

SPEC:DROPSHIP_0 OFFSET:$00 RAM:$4000
AZIMUTH:000° ELEVATION:000° ROLL:000°

0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	.BYTE $00,$00,$00
1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	0	1	0	0	.BYTE $FF,$FF,$F4
1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	.BYTE $FF,$FF,$64
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	.BYTE $AA,$A9,$54
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	.BYTE $AA,$A5,$00
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	.BYTE $AA,$9A,$D4
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	1	1	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	0	1			.BYTE $AA,$6F,$51
1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $FF,$FD,$40
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $AA,$A9,$00
1	0	1	0	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $AF,$E9,$00
1	0	1	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $BA,$99,$00
1	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $EA,$99,$00
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $AA,$99,$00
0	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $6A,$99,$00
0	1	0	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $5A,$99,$00
1	0	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $95,$59,$00
1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $A5,$69,$00
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $AA,$A9,$00
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $AA,$A9,$00
1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $FF,$E9,$00
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $AA,$99,$00

BASE_COLOR:□ MULTI_COLOR0:■ MULTI_COLOR1:▒

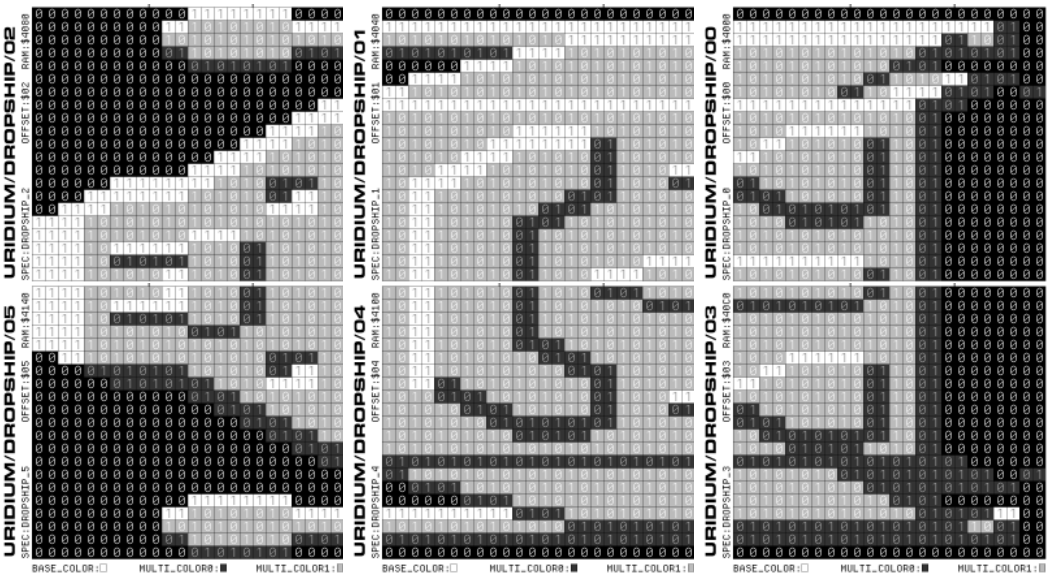
URIDIUM/DROPSHIP/03

SPEC:DROPSHIP_3 OFFSET:$03 RAM:$40C0
AZIMUTH:000° ELEVATION:000° ROLL:000°

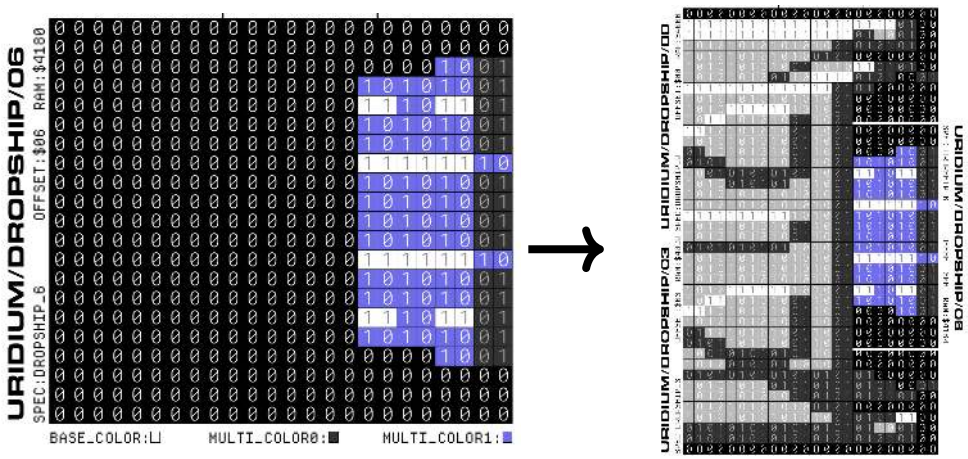
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $AA,$99,$00
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $55,$69,$00
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $AA,$A9,$00
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $AA,$A9,$00
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $AA,$A9,$00
1	0	1	0	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $AF,$E9,$00
1	0	1	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $BA,$99,$00
1	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $EA,$99,$00
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $AA,$99,$00
0	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $6A,$99,$00
0	1	0	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $5A,$99,$00
1	0	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $95,$59,$00
1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $A5,$69,$00
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $55,$55,$40
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	0	1			.BYTE $AA,$55,$51
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0			.BYTE $AA,$95,$54
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $AA,$A5,$00
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	0	1	1	1	0	0			.BYTE $AA,$A9,$5C
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0			.BYTE $55,$55,$64
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0			.BYTE $55,$55,$54
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			.BYTE $00,$00,$00

BASE_COLOR:□ MULTI_COLOR0:■ MULTI_COLOR1:▒

But if we zoom in slightly we can also see more about the order in which the sprites are composed.

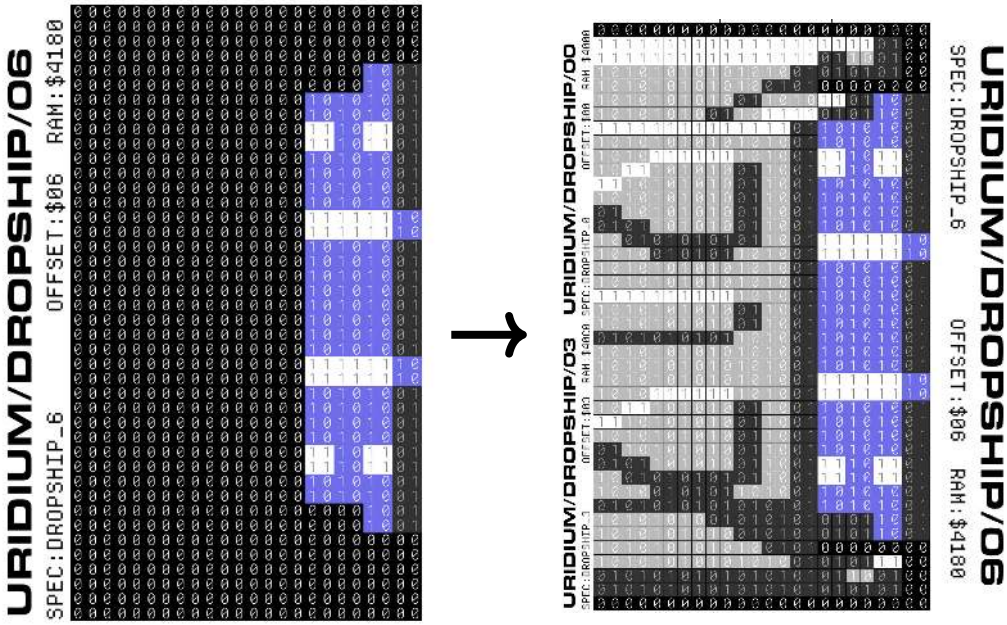


We haven't included the landing bay at the rear of the craft in the montage above. This is because there's a wrinkle we have to take account of in our addition of the sprite that depicts the landing deck. This is evident when we see what happens we attempt it add it to the stern of the dropship below: it's too small!



Why is this? Why doesn't it work like all the other sprites that make up the dropship?

And what do we have to do to make it work? The answer is that we have to render the sprite in a slightly different way. We have to render each row of bits twice. So our rendered sprite will be twice as high as a normal sprite, with 42 rows of pixels rather than 21, and with each of the 21 rows in our data duplicated. How this works in practice is illustrated below. And now the landing deck sprite fits neatly into place in the rear of the drop ship!



Now that we have an idea of how it has to work, let's briefly look at how the composition of the drop ship is implemented in practice. For each section that makes up the ship we will have an array of bytes detailing its position, its color mode, and most importantly the actual sprite value to use. For example, this is what the section array will look like for the section on the top right.

```
topRightSection
  .BYTE $00       ; Sprite's index.
  .BYTE $82       ; Sprite's X position.
  .BYTE $00       ; Sprite's supplemental X position.
  .BYTE $8D       ; Sprite's Y position.
  .BYTE $FF       ; Sprite Enabled/Disabled.
  .BYTE $00       ; Expand Vertical Off.
  .BYTE $00       ; Display Priority vs background.
  .BYTE $FF       ; Multi-Color Mode On.
  .BYTE $00       ; Expand Horizontal Off.
  .BYTE M_GRAY2   ; Sprite color (MULTI_COLOR_1).
  .BYTE [illegible]       ; Sprite Reference ($00).
```

And this is what the section array looks like for the landing deck. Notice that the byte that controls vertical expansion is different from the value used for the `topRightSection`. It is set to $FF, indicating that each row of the sprite should be duplicated, doubling its vertical height as we require.

```
landingDeckSection
  .BYTE $07      ; Sprite's index.
  .BYTE $82      ; Sprite's X position.
  .BYTE $00      ; Sprite's supplemental X position.
  .BYTE $8E      ; Sprite's Y position.
  .BYTE $FF      ; Sprite Enabled.
  .BYTE $FF      ; Expand Vertical ON.
  .BYTE $00      ; Display Priority vs background.
  .BYTE $FF      ; Multi-Color Mode On.
  .BYTE $00      ; Expand Horizontal Off.
  .BYTE M_LTBLUE ; Sprite color (MULTI_COLOR_1).
  .BYTE [illegible]       ; Sprite Reference ($06).
```

With the details of each section defined in its own section array, we will now define an array that references each one. A 'list of lists' if you like. [1] Taken together, this array tells us the order in which to place the sections. This order is important because when we draw one sprite after another each will obscure the one before it, occluding any overlapping area.

```
loPtrsToDropShipSections
  .BYTE <topRightSection,     <topMiddleSection   ; [illegible]
  .BYTE <topLeftSection,      <bottomRightSection ; [illegible]
  .BYTE <bottomMiddleSection, <bottomLeftSection  ; [illegible]
  .BYTE <bayDoorSection,  <landingDeckSection     ; [illegible]
```

Finally, we draw the drop ship using these data structures:

```
  LDX #$07                       ; Start at the end of the section array.
DrawDropShip
  LDA loPtrsToDropShipSections,X ; Get the X'th section from the array.
  STA sectionDataLoPtr           ; Store it.
  LDA hiPtrsToDropShipSections,X ; Get the X'th section from the array.
  STA sectionDataHiPtr           ; Store it.
  JSR LoadAndDisplaySectionData  ; Load the section and display it.
  DEX                            ; Move to the next section..
  BPL DrawDropShip               ; .. until we reach the first one.
```

In this snippet of code we iterate over the array of sections, starting at the end of the

[1] We actually define and use another as well: `hiPtrsToDropShipSections`. This references the sections in the same order as `loPtrsToDropShipSections`. We combine the entries in these arrays to get the two-byte address in memory where our section, such as `topRightSection`, is located and read its data. This is what you see happening in `DrawDropShip`.

array rather than the beginning, and draw each section. This means that the earlier sections will occlude the later ones. Because the landing deck is at the end of the section array this means that any overlapping parts of the deck will be occluded by the section above it, as we would expect if we were looking at in practice.

The illustration below shows how the craft is built up by the loop in `DrawDropShip` above. We start with the landing deck and proceed clockwise along the whole body of the dropship until it is complete.

BAY/DOOR

The bay doors of the dropship open gradually to reveal the landing deck. At first there is just a peek:

But then the teeth of the doors become visible as well and the landing deck underneath starts to becom clear:

The doors begin to recede fully into their housing:

URIDIUM/BAY/DOOR/09

SPEC:DROPSHIP_9 OFFSET:$09 RAM:$4240

```
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$03
.BYTE $00,$00,$C7
.BYTE $00,$00,$C7
.BYTE $00,$00,$E3
.BYTE $00,$00,$E3
.BYTE $00,$00,$C7
.BYTE $00,$00,$C7
.BYTE $00,$00,$E3
.BYTE $00,$00,$E3
.BYTE $00,$00,$C7
.BYTE $00,$00,$C7
.BYTE $00,$00,$E3
.BYTE $00,$00,$E3
.BYTE $00,$00,$C7
.BYTE $00,$00,$C7
.BYTE $00,$00,$03
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
```

URIDIUM/DROPSHIP/03 OFFSET:$03 RAM:$40C0 SPEC:DROPSHIP_0 URIDIUM/DROPSHIP/00 OFFSET:$00 RAM:$4000 SPEC:DROPSHIP_3

URIDIUM/BAY/DOOR/09

SPEC:DROPSHIP_9 OFFSET:$09 RAM:$4240

URIDIUM/BAY/DOOR/10

SPEC:DROPSHIP_10 OFFSET:$0A RAM:$4280

```
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$01
.BYTE $00,$00,$83
.BYTE $00,$00,$83
.BYTE $00,$00,$C1
.BYTE $00,$00,$C1
.BYTE $00,$00,$83
.BYTE $00,$00,$83
.BYTE $00,$00,$C1
.BYTE $00,$00,$C1
.BYTE $00,$00,$83
.BYTE $00,$00,$83
.BYTE $00,$00,$C1
.BYTE $00,$00,$C1
.BYTE $00,$00,$83
.BYTE $00,$00,$83
.BYTE $00,$00,$01
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
.BYTE $00,$00,$00
```

URIDIUM/DROPSHIP/03 OFFSET:$03 RAM:$40C0 SPEC:DROPSHIP_0 URIDIUM/DROPSHIP/00 OFFSET:$00 RAM:$4000 SPEC:DROPSHIP_3

URIDIUM/BAY/DOOR/10

SPEC:DROPSHIP_10 OFFSET:$0A RAM:$4280

Finally the doors recede completely and the landing deck is fully revealed:

In the diagrams opposite we can see that there is something subtly different about the sprites used to achieve this effect. Close inspection of the diagrams on the left hand side shows that, unlike those used for the Manta and the main body of the drop ship, we do not use bit-pairs to define our pixels. Instead we have a single color, and a '1' bit indicates a pixel while a '0' bit indicates blank space.

This allows much greater granularity in the definition of the doors as they open - enabling the 'teeth' of the doors to be defined to a single pixel level. The diagrams on the right hand side show how the bay door sprite is placed relative to the rest of the drop-ship. As we can see the bay door sprite occludes the landing deck below, because it is drawn after it in the order we defined in `loPtrsToDropShipSections` in the previous chapter.

The switch that enables the pixel-grained rendering of the sprites is defined in the section array for the door (highlighted with exclamation marks below). Because Multi-Color mode is turned off for the sprite every '1' bit in the definition is treated as a single pixel. Notice also that the X and Y position of the sprite are the same as the `landingDeckSection` we looked at earlier - because we are drawing over it in order to cover the deck completely with the closed bay door.

```
bayDoorSection
  .BYTE $06      ; Sprite's index (spriteIndex).
  .BYTE $82      ; Sprite's X position.
  .BYTE $00      ; Sprite's supplemental X position.
  .BYTE $8E      ; Sprite's Y position.
  .BYTE $FF      ; Sprite Enabled.
  .BYTE $FF      ; Expand Vertical On.
  .BYTE $00      ; Display Priority vs background.
  .BYTE $00      ; !!! Multi-Color Mode OFF.
  .BYTE $00      ; Expand Horizontal Off.
  .BYTE M_GRAY3  ; Sprite color (MULTI_COLOR_1).
  .BYTE ▌        ; Sprite Value ($07).
```

When it comes to animating the bay door opening sequence, our procedure consists of updating the sprite in place by slowly incrementing the 'Sprite Value' that references the starting position of the closed bay door (07 - ▌) to the final, fully open position (11 - ⋮). We are updating the sprite 'in place', changing nothing but the pixel content of

the sprite itself. Everything else, its position and all other parameters, stay the same.

```
OpenBayDoorsLoop
  LDA #$06                  ; Load the sprite index for bayDoorSection
  STA spriteIndex           ; And store it in spriteIndex.
  JSR GetCurrentSprite      ; Load the cached data for the bay door.
  INC currentSpriteValue    ; Increment the 'Sprite Value'.
  JSR DisplayCurrentSprite  ; Display the new sprite.
  JSR CheckInputAndWait     ; Wait..
  JSR CheckInputAndWait     ; Keep waiting..
  JSR CheckInputAndWait     ; Keep waiting..
  LDA currentSpriteValue    ; Get the current 'Sprite Value'.
  CMP #DROPSHIP_11          ; Have we reached the last bay door sprite?
  BCC OpenBayDoorsLoop      ; If not, keep looping.
```

The full effect of this procedure is given again below, showing us paint the closed drop-ship door (`DROPSHIP_7`) all the way up to the door when fully open (`DROPSHIP_11`):

Once the bay doors have opened. The Manta can emerge. To achieve this we replace the sprite used for the bay door (defined in `bayDoorSection`) with a new definition we call `mantaTakingOff`. Notice that the 'index' of `'06'` is the same in this definition but we change sprite we're referencing with the Manta's sprite, as well as enabling multi-color mode to ensure we draw the Manta correctly. 'Replacing' the bay door in this way ensure that it occurs in the same position as the doors in relation to the other objects, i.e. above the landing deck but below the rest of the craft. This is essential to achieve the 'emerging' effect:

```
mantaTakingOff
  .BYTE $06      ; Sprite's index (spriteIndex).
  .BYTE $70      ; Sprite's X position.
  .BYTE $00      ; Sprite's supplemental X position.
  .BYTE $98      ; Sprite's Y position.
  .BYTE $FF      ; Sprite Enabled.
  .BYTE $00      ; Expand Vertical Off.
  .BYTE $00      ; Display Priority vs background.
  .BYTE $FF      ; Multi-Color Mode On.
  .BYTE $00      ; Expand Horizontal Off.
  .BYTE M_BLACK  ; Sprite color (MULTI_COLOR_1).
  .BYTE [illegible]      ; Sprite Value ($59).
```

To swap out `bayDoorSection` with `mantaTakingOff` we must load `mantaTakingOff` into memory. The fact that it has the same index of `'06'` ensures that we replace `bayDoorSection`:

```
  ; Replace the bay door sprite with the manta sprite.
  JSR CheckInputAndWait
  LDA hiPtrToMantaTakingOff
  STA spriteVariablesHiPtr
  LDA loPtrToMantaTakingOff
  STA spriteVariablesLoPtr
  JSR LoadSpriteVariablesAndDisplay
```

With this done we can now perform the animation. This consists of loading the sprite, updating its X position, and redisplaying it. We then repeat this process until the Manta reaches the middle of the screen, which is around pixel position 170:

```
MoveMantaOutOfDropShip
  LDA #$06                  ; Load the sprite index for mantaTakingOff
  STA spriteIndex           ; And store it in spriteIndex.
  JSR GetCurrentSprite      ; Load the cached data for the manta.
  INC currentSpriteXPos     ; Increment the Manta's X position.
  JSR DisplayCurrentSprite  ; Display the manta in the new position.
  JSR CheckInputAndWait     ; Wait..
  JSR CheckInputAndWait     ; Keep waiting..
  LDA currentSpriteXPos     ; Get the Manta's current position.
  CMP #170                  ; Loop until it reaches 170.
  BCC MoveMantaOutOfDropShip
```

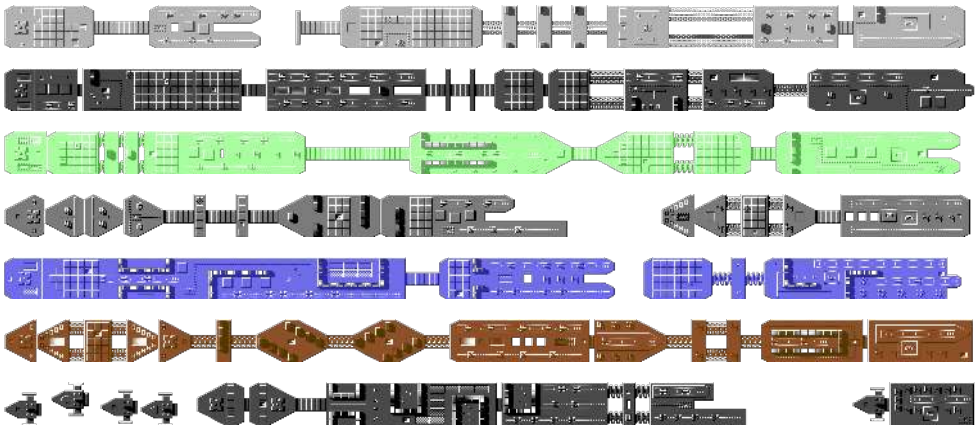
The effect is illustrated below. An interesting detail, which you may have noticed, is that the Manta is the wrong colour. Notice that it's detailing is grey rather than yellow.

This isn't entirely deliberate - the color immediately changes back to yellow once the game starts - so it would have to be an either oversight or the result of an unavoidable constraint. It happens to be the latter - the color of the detailing is determined by a color value shared by all sprites. This isn't a problem during gameplay as the enemies also use this yellow color value, for example:.

However during the dropship sequence this shared color is a dull grey, the shadow tones used to give depth to the dropship. As a result, during deployment the Manta must carry gray rather than yellow racing stripes. Once the player takes control, however, it can revert immediately to the color it shares with the enemies. On the first level, this is yellow, but this color also changes in the later stages of the game to pink, blue, and so on.

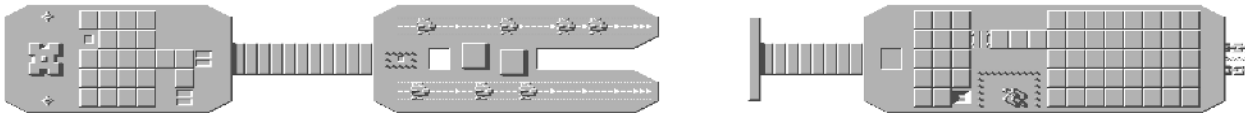
DREAD/NOUGHT

The levels in Uridium are beautiful things. But we never get to take them in all at once. Here are a selection, shrunk down to fit a page.

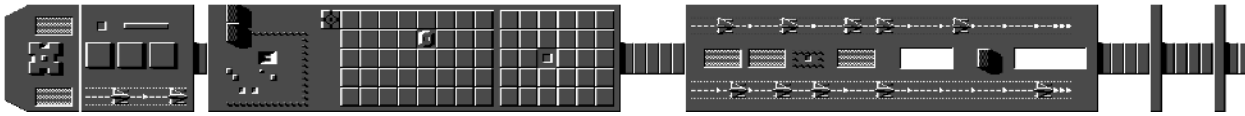


Let's zoom in a bit and see what they look like closer up.

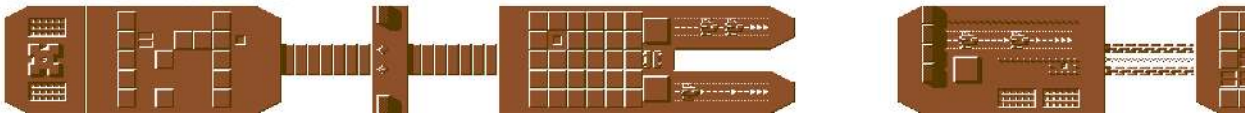
URIDIUM/01/ZINC



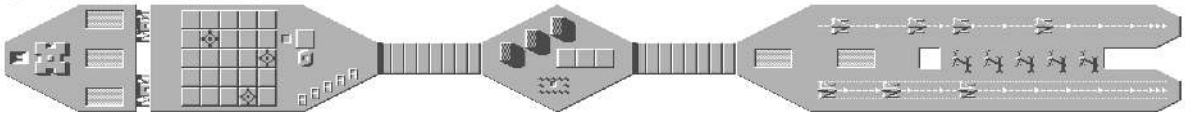
URIDIUM/02/LEAD



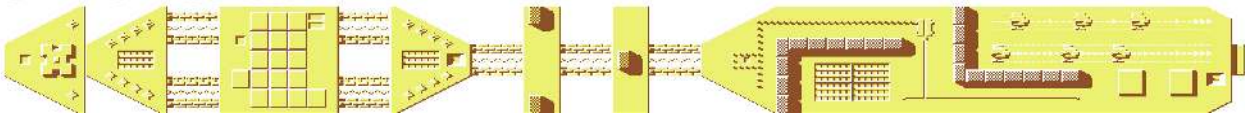
URIDIUM/03/COPPER



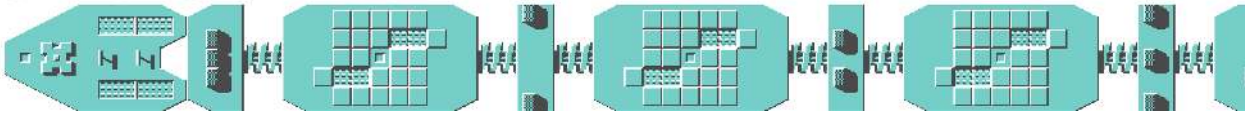
URIDIUM/04/SILVER



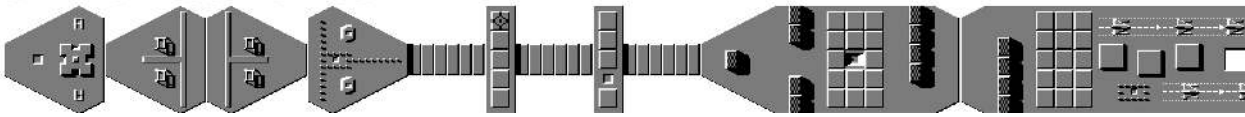
URIDIUM/06/GOLD

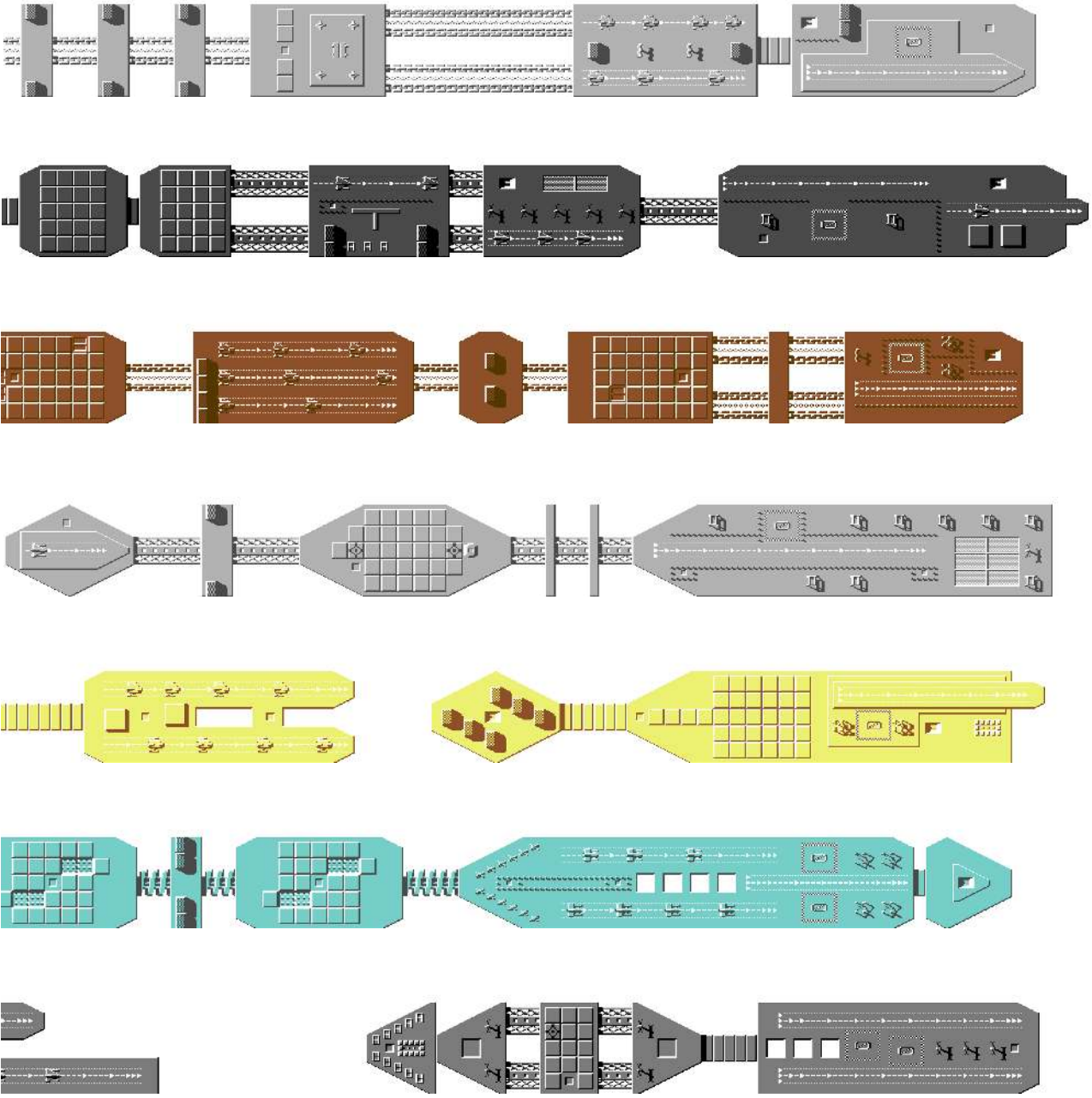


URIDIUM/07/PLATINUM



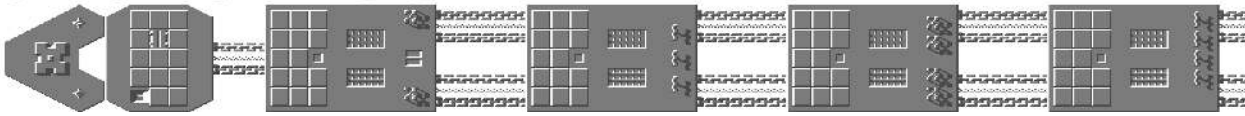
URIDIUM/08/TUNGSTEN



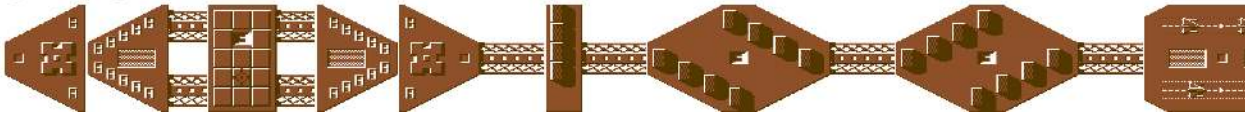


URIDIUM/09/IRIDON

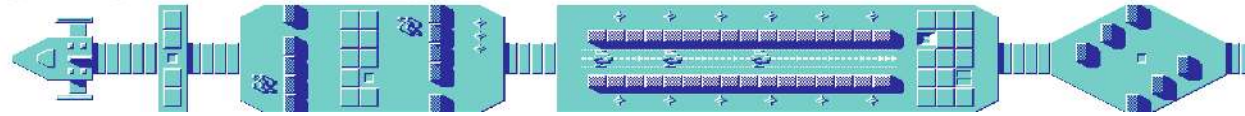
URIDIUM/10/KALLISTO



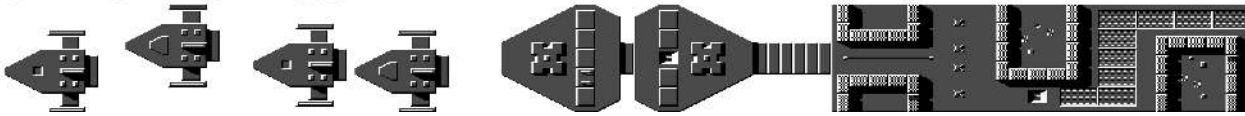
URIDIUM/11/TRI-ALLOY



URIDIUM/12/QUADMIUM

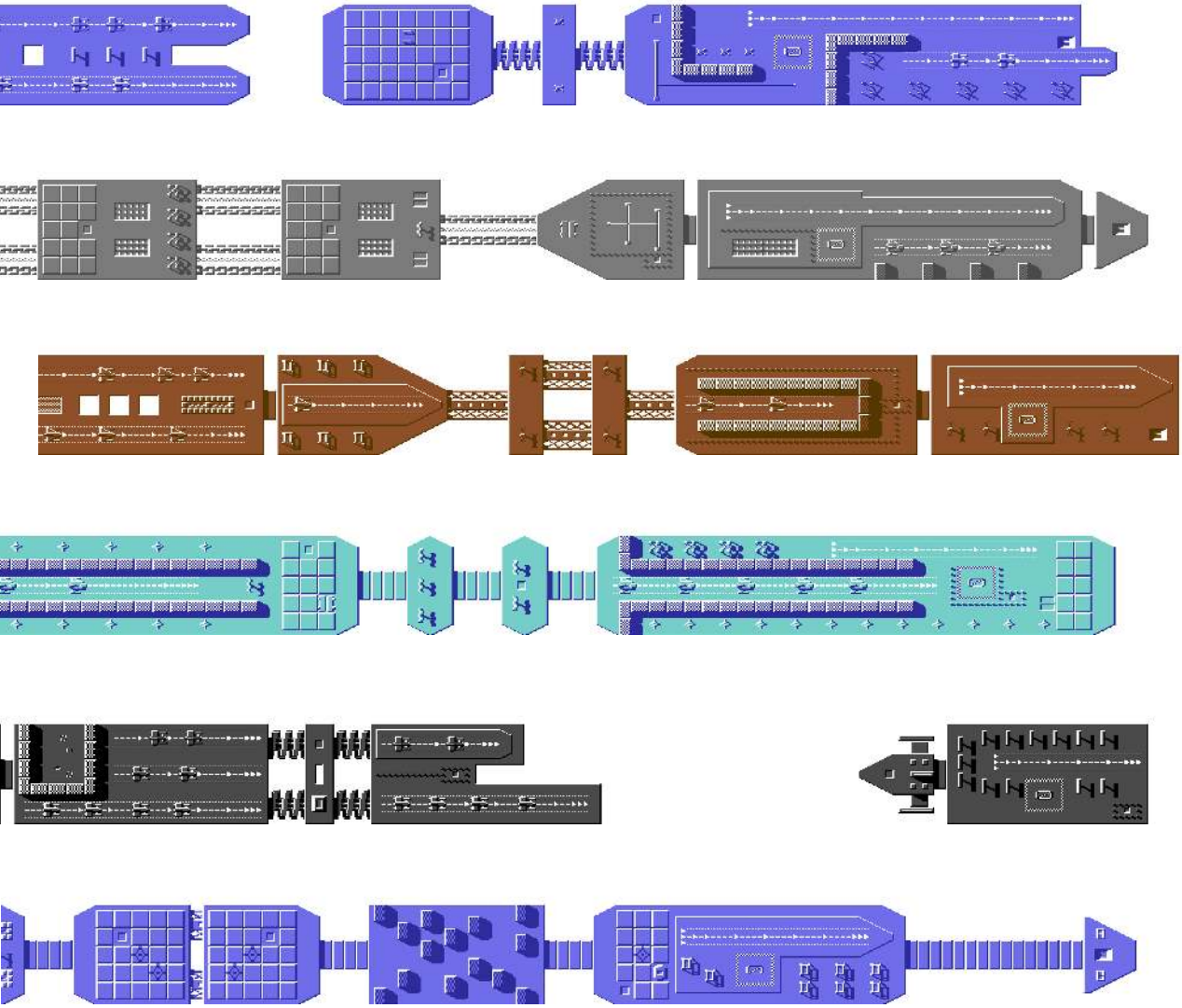


URIDIUM/13/ERGONITE



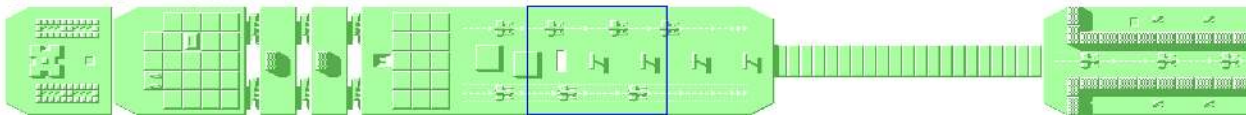
URIDIUM/14/GALACTIUM

URIDIUM/15/URIDIUM



GOOD ZAPPING... TURKEY.

URIDIUM/05/IRON

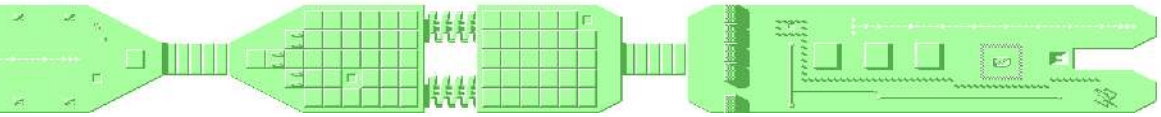


If we zoom in on a section of one of the dreadnoughts (the blue inset above) we can get a sense of the constituent parts of the whole.

URIDIUM/05/IRON/AIRSTRIP

26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26	26
25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25
54	54	54	54	94	95	96	54	54	54	54	54	54	54	94	95	96	54	54	54	54	54	94	
56	55	55	55	97	98	99	55	55	55	56	55	55	55	97	98	99	55	55	55	56	55	97	
58	58	58	58	9A	9B	9C	58	58	58	58	58	58	58	9A	9B	9C	58	58	58	58	58	9A	
25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25
25	25	25	25	25	40	24	3E	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25
26	26	29	4C	25	28	20	22	25	25	25	8D	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	8D	25	25	25	
25	25	28	4D	25	28	20	22	25	25	25	8E	F4	F7	25	25	25	25	25	8E	F4	F7	25	
25	25	28	4D	25	28	20	22	25	25	25	8F	F5	F6	25	25	25	25	25	8F	F5	F6	25	
24	24	27	4D	25	41	26	3F	25	25	25	25	25	F8	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	F8	25	
4F	4F	4F	50	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	
54	54	54	54	54	54	94	95	96	54	54	54	54	54	54	54	54	94	95	96	54	54	54	
56	55	55	55	55	56	97	98	99	55	56	55	55	55	55	56	55	97	98	99	56	55	55	
58	58	58	58	58	58	9A	9B	9C	58	58	58	58	58	58	58	58	9A	9B	9C	58	58	58	
25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	
24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	24	

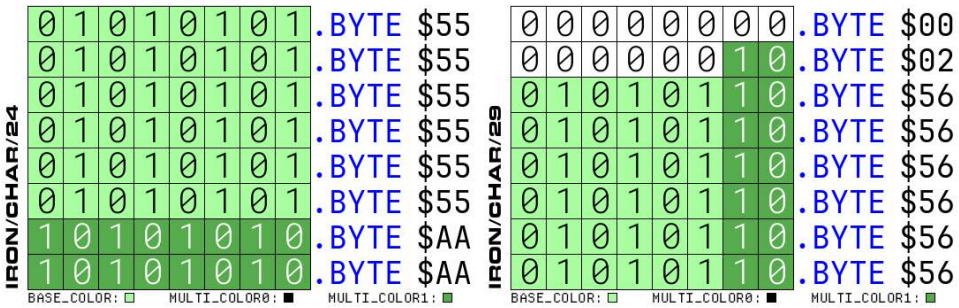
What we find is that the dreadnought is composed of small square tiles. Each type of tile has its own identifier, or index number, and with these we can build a complete dreadnought, fitting them together as appropriate. In total each dreadnought can be up to 512 tiles wide and 17 tiles high, giving a total quantity of 8704 tiles required to create an entire ship. Our indexing scheme allows up to 255 different types of tiles so we are not short of the potential for complexity. In just the section we have extracted above we have used 28 different tiles.



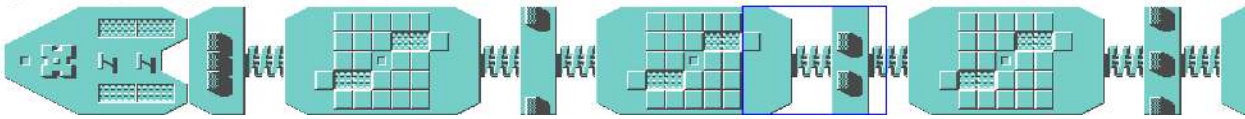
It is easier to see what the individual tiles look like if we set them out individually. Here they are, in descending order of frequency with which they appear in our diagram:

We are clearly dealing with abstract forms that only make sense when composed together. Looking more closely at the diagram opposite we can apprehend a distinction between two different ways in which the tiles are used to render the dreadnought. The first is that low-numbered tiles tend to be used to draw the surface areas of the ship. The second is that relatively high-numbered tiles are used to form the structures that are dotted across it. This distinction will prove important in the following two chapters when we look at the way the game stores and constructs the dreadnoughts.

Before we do that though, there is yet another level of granularity to which we can zoom down. This is the detail required to render each of the constituent tiles. Each tile is defined by an array of eight bytes. This scheme is very similar to the one used for sprites but instead defines a graphical element that is eight pixels wide by eight pixels high. Putting tiles 24 and 8D side by side we get a sense of how each color unit is defined by a bitpair, giving us a tile that is four color units wide and eight color units tall.

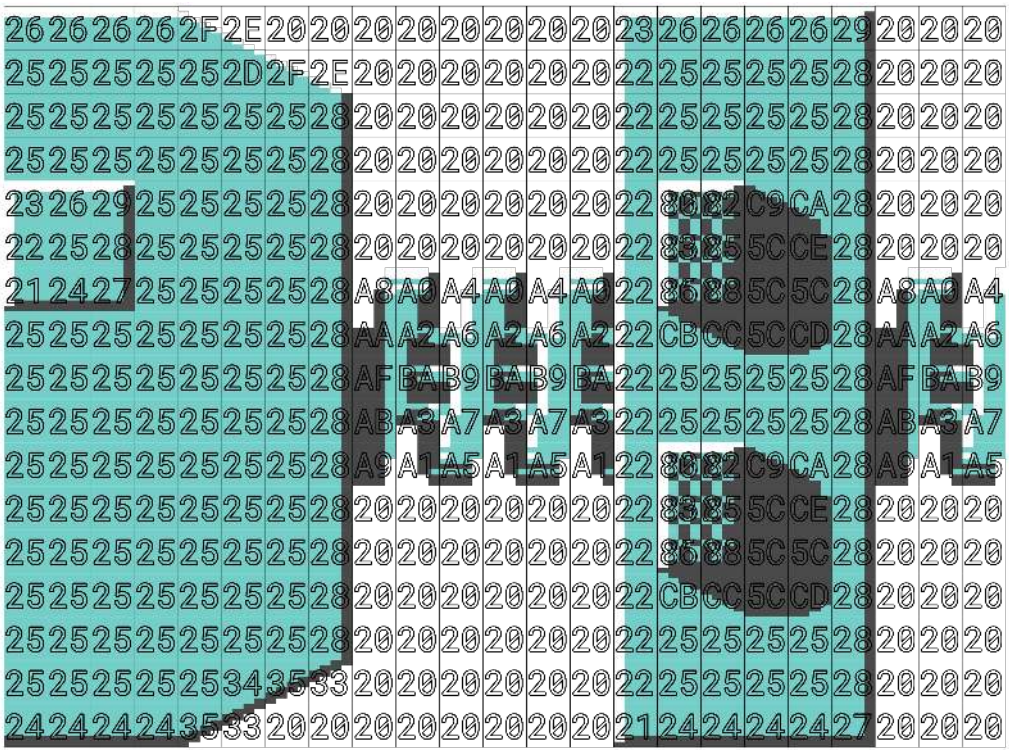


URIDIUM/07/PLATINUM

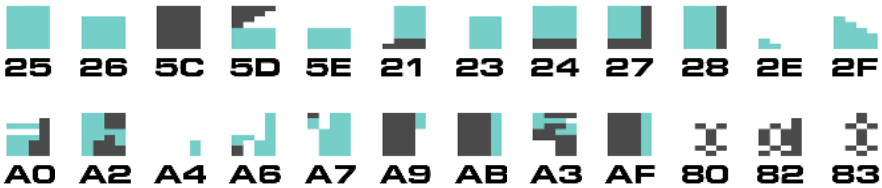


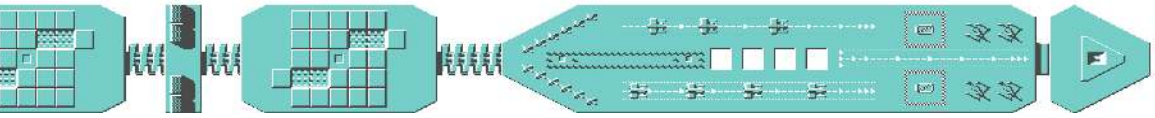
Before we move on to examining how the surface of the dreadnought and its structures are stored and constructed by the game, let's look at the segment of another level. This time it's the dreadnought that makes up level 7. We focus in on a section of coupling that binds one carriage with another.

URIDIUM/07/PLATINUM/COUPLING



We find many of the tiles we are using here are the same as in the previous level, especially when defining the surface of the dreadnought.





The bevelled square on the left hand side - - likewise uses a combination of tiles similar to the bevel in the previous level - . The main difference lies only in the color scheme. When we look at the bitpairs forming the tiles, the principle is the same and essentially the same definition for these lower numbered tiles, which define common surface elements, is shared between the levels.

PLATINUM/CHAR/24

0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	.BYTE $55
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	.BYTE $55
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	.BYTE $55
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	.BYTE $55
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	.BYTE $55
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	.BYTE $55
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	.BYTE $AA
1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	.BYTE $AA

BASE_COLOR: MULTI_COLOR0: MULTI_COLOR1:

PLATINUM/CHAR/26

0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	.BYTE $00
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	.BYTE $00
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	.BYTE $55
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	.BYTE $55
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	.BYTE $55
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	.BYTE $55
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	.BYTE $55
0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	.BYTE $55

BASE_COLOR: MULTI_COLOR0: MULTI_COLOR1:

PLATINUM/CHAR/28

0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56
0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56
0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56
0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56
0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56
0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56
0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56
0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56

BASE_COLOR: MULTI_COLOR0: MULTI_COLOR1:

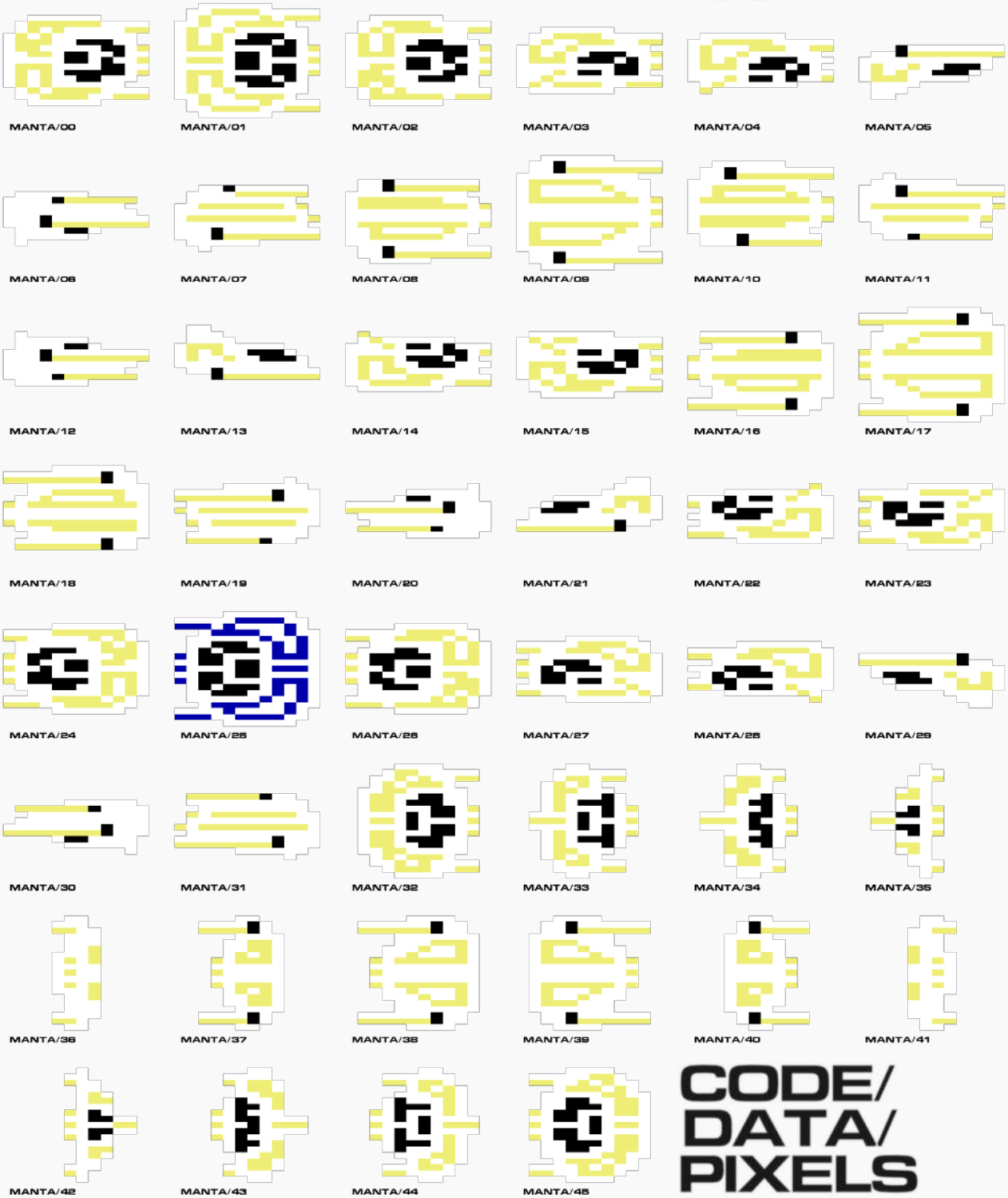
PLATINUM/CHAR/29

0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	.BYTE $00
0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	.BYTE $02
0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56
0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56
0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56
0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56
0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56
0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	.BYTE $56

BASE_COLOR: MULTI_COLOR0: MULTI_COLOR1:

As we shall shortly see this isn't true for all tiles, particularly those that define structures placed on the surface.

URIDIUM/ FRAKTION



CODE/ DATA/ PIXELS